



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2023-24
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET B)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

General Instructions:

- The question paper consists of six printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.
- Reading Time: 10 minutes
- Writing time is not included in the reading time

SECTION A

Question 1

Choose and write the most appropriate option:

[1x10=10]

a) ___ Diya is a graceful dancer, her facial expressions need improvement. (Fill in the blank with a suitable conjunction)

- i. As ii. Because iii. Besides iv. Although

b) Unless you behave yourself, I ___ you out. (Fill in the blank with the suitable Tense form)

- i. would have taken ii. will not take iii. may take iv. will take

c) Choose the sentence with the correct position of Adverb.

- i. Deployed usually is a word used with soldiers.
ii. I go out for movies seldom.
iii. I generally do not mingle with disrespectful individuals.
iv. Gracefully danced in the rain the peacocks.

d) Choose the sentence with the correct position of Adverb.

- i. Sherlock Holmes seldom makes a mistake.
ii. Rarely we do find Feluda not solving a case.
iii. Nancy Drew found the caviar spicy too.
iv. Tintin turned down respectfully the Oriental Jewel Adventure.

- e) They had to borrow a bicycle from a stranger. (Change the voice of the given sentence)
- A stranger was asked to borrow a bicycle.
 - A bicycle had to be borrowed from a stranger.
 - We borrowed a bicycle from a stranger.
 - Borrowing a bicycle from a stranger was done by them.
- f) The shopkeeper ____ stocked well before the sale _____. (Fill in the blank with a correct Tense form)
- has, starts
 - had, will start
 - had, started
 - will, will start
- g) The boat is being rowed by three men. (Change the voice of the given sentence)
- By whom is the boat been rowed?
 - Three men rowed the boat.
 - Three men are rowing the boat.
 - Let the boat be rowed by three men.
- h) The doctor failed to save his son from Covid. (Identify the figure of speech)
- Irony
 - Metaphor
 - Personification
 - Simile
- i) Try not to ____ in the middle of your presentation. (Fill in the blank with a suitable Phrasal verb)
- pass off
 - cast down
 - break off
 - come round
- j) It will not be wise to leave the class ____ we hear the bell ring. (Fill in the blank with a suitable conjunction)
- if
 - when
 - until
 - while

SECTION B

Question 2

(Do not spend more than 30 minutes on this question.)

Write a composition (350-400 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- Describe your favourite time of the day. What are the sights, sounds, smells and feelings that you associate with your favourite time? Why do you like this part of the day better than the others?
- 'AI or Artificial Intelligence is killing creativity.' Express your views either for or against this statement.
- Study the picture given in the next page. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 3

(Do not spend more than 20 minutes on this question.)

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- a) Your friend and you have planned a day out with your friends at a local organic farm. Your friend's father who lives in another city objects to your plan. Write a letter to him appealing against his decision and highlighting the benefits of your plan.
- b) While you were walking on the road the day before, you were robbed off your brand-new phone. Write a letter to the Officer in Charge of the local Police Station, giving an accurate account of the incident. You may include details which you think are important, such as the time and place of attack, description of the item robbed and the robber.

Question 4

Write a Notice on the following topic.

[5]

Write a notice to be put up on the school notice board informing the students of classes VIII-XII about an Inter House Cultural Festival on the occasion of 'Azadi ka Amrit Mahotsav'.

Question 5

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

At school everybody seemed to be overwhelmed by the thought of the examinations. It was weeks since anybody had seen a smile on Shankar's face. Somu had become brisk and businesslike. Mohit took time to grasp jokes and seldom made any either. Rajam came to school at the stroke of the first bell, took down everything the teacher said and left at the stroke of the last bell, hardly uttering a dozen words to anybody. Mani was beginning to look worried and took every opportunity to take Shankar aside and have his doubts cleared. There

was a general belief in the school that the clerk was omniscient and knew all the question papers of all the classes.

One day Mani went to the clerk's house and laid a neat bundle containing fresh brinjals at his feet. The clerk was pleased and took Mani in and seated him on a stool. The clerk looked extremely amiable and Mani felt that he could ask anything at that moment and get it. The clerk was murmuring something about his cat, a lank ill-fed thing that was nestling close to him. Most of what he was saying did not enter Mani's head. He was waiting to open the topic of question papers. The clerk had meanwhile passed from cats to eye-flies but it made little difference to Mani who was waiting for the other to pause for breath to launch his attack. 'You must never let these eye-flies buzz near your eyes. All cases of eyesore can be traced on it. When you get eyesore, the only thing you can do is to place a slice of raw onion on the sore.'

Mani realised that the other would not stop and butted in, 'There is only a week more for the examination, sir...'

The clerk was slightly puzzled. 'Yes. Indeed, a week more...You must take care to choose only the juicy variety, the large juicy variety, not the small onion...'

'Sir,' Mani interrupted, ignoring the juicy variety, 'I am much worried about my examination.' He tried to look pathetic.

'I am glad. If you read well, you will pass,' said the clerk.

'You see, sir, I am so worried. I don't sleep at night, thinking of the examination. If you could possibly tell me something important...I have such a lot to study – I don't want to study unnecessary things that may not be necessary for the examination.' He meandered thus. The clerk understood what he was driving at but said, 'Just read all your portions and you will pass.' Mani realised that diplomacy was not his line. He asked bluntly, 'Please tell me, sir, what questions are we getting for examination?'

The clerk denied having any knowledge of the question papers. Mani flattered him by asking if he did not know the questions, who else would. By just a little more of the same judicious flattery, the clerk was moved to give what Mani believed to be 'valuable hints'. Although he did not know what the First Form tests were, the clerk ventured to advise, 'You must pay particular attention to Geography. Maybe you will have to practice map-drawing a lot. In Arithmetic, make it a point to solve at least five problems every day.'

'And what about English?'

'Oh, don't worry about that. Have you read all your lessons?'

'Yes, sir,' Mani replied without conviction. It is all right then.

The clerk said, 'You must read all the important lessons again and if you have time, read again and that will be ample.'

These answers satisfied Mani greatly. On his way home, he smiled to himself and said that the four annas he had invested on brinjals was not after all a waste.

- a) Give the meaning of each of the following words as used in the passage. One word answers or short phrases will be accepted:

[3]

- i. brisk
- ii. amiable
- iii. puzzled

b) Answer the following questions briefly in your own words:

- i. What gift did Mani bring for the clerk? Why do you think he brought it? [2]
- ii. Which word in the passage describes the clerk as all-knowing? [1]
- iii. What did the clerk believe was the reason for eyesore? What was the remedy? [2]
- iv. Why do you think Mani tried to look pathetic while speaking about his examination? What did Mani ask the clerk bluntly? [2]
- v. Why do you think Mani actually did not get any help from the clerk to pass his exams? [2]

c) In not more than 50 words mention what effect did the upcoming examinations have on the children. [8]

Question 6

Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. [½ x 8=4]

Example; (0) leave.

I usually ___(0)___ (left) for school at seven in the morning. Yesterday, I ___(1)___ (be) late as I ___(2)___ (leave) home at seven-ten. While ___(3)___ (walk) on the road, I ___(4)___ (notice) a child standing on the other side of the road and ___(5)___ (wave) its little arms. I ___(6)___ (think) that the baby wanted help from someone. Although I was in great hurry, I ___(7)___ (decide) to help the child. No sooner did I ___(8)___ (cross) the road than the child disappeared.

Question 7

Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using *and*, *but* or *so*.

[1x4=4]

- a) Tina injured her right leg. She wanted to perform in the dance competition.
- b) I gifted a pen to my brother. My brother lives in Australia.
- c) I recited a poem. I sang a folk song.
- d) The parcel could not be delivered. Nobody was at home.

Class 8

Do as directed:

[7]

- a) The farmer said, "It is impossible to make profit at such low selling price". (Change to indirect speech)
- b) None listened to Mohan's call for help. (Change to Passive Voice)
- c) I was ___ by the traffic police for jumping the red light. (Fill in the blank with the appropriate phrasal verb)

- d) Meeta met the members of the Mitra Club. (Identify the figure of speech)**
- e) My friend said to me, "Helping you during your illness has given me a lot of happiness."
(Change the speech of the sentence)**
- f) Let your ideas be shared. (Change the voice)**
- g) Sobha pleaded her sister to accompany her to the local market the following day.
(Change to Direct Speech)**